

LESSON GUIDE

Perspective & Volume

Perspective is the mathematical system that makes flat surfaces appear three-dimensional. This lesson covers one-, two-, and three-point perspective, the horizon line, and the rules that govern how all parallel lines in a scene converge as they recede into space.

4-WEEK PLAN

Week 1 — One-Point Perspective

Draw a simple interior using one-point perspective. Find the vanishing point and run all receding lines toward it. Practice with box forms first.

Week 2 — Two-Point Perspective

Draw exterior views of buildings and boxes using two vanishing points. Work on measuring consistent widths between receding lines.

Week 3 — Three-Point Perspective

Add a third vanishing point above or below the horizon to create dramatic viewpoints. Draw the same building from ant-view and bird-view.

Week 4 — Objects in Space

Draw a scene with multiple objects at different scales and distances, each constructed with correct perspective. Add cast shadows using the light-source method.

KEY CONCEPTS

One-Point Perspective

All receding lines converge at a single vanishing point on the horizon. Used for corridors, straight-on views of rooms and roads.

Two-Point Perspective

Two vanishing points on the horizon handle the two sets of receding horizontal edges on any box-like form seen from a corner angle.

Three-Point Perspective

A third vanishing point above or below the horizon controls the vertical edges when looking up or down at a subject.

Overlapping & Scale

Overlap creates unambiguous depth — overlapping shapes read as in front. Size diminution (things appear smaller as they recede) reinforces depth.

Horizon Line & Eye Level

The horizon line is always at your eye level. Everything above it is seen from below; everything below is seen from above. Changing it changes everything.

Boxes in Space

The ability to draw boxes convincingly in perspective from any angle is the core skill that unlocks all other form drawing. Practice daily.

ESSENTIAL RESOURCES

- [Perspective Made Easy](#) — Ernest Norling (free on Archive.org)
- [drawabox.com](#) — Free perspective and 3D form course
- [Scott Robertson](#) — How to Draw (comprehensive perspective reference)
- [Ctrl+Paint](#) — Perspective fundamentals playlist
- [Peter Han Dynamic Sketching](#) — YouTube perspective demonstrations